

BUILDING FRIENDSHIPS

The word “friendship” rarely appears in scripture (5 times in the ESV). Instead we find the phrase “one another” in reference to our relationship with others (159 times in the ESV). Out of the overflow of what Christ has done for us, we can love, honor, encourage and submit humbly to one another; this is the basis for any biblical friendship.

**Scan the QR code to see a compiled list of 20 “one anothers” in Scripture.

3 Principles for Building Friendships

1. Courageous Vulnerability (How would you define it?)

1 John 1:6-7 “If we say we have fellowship with him while we walk in darkness, we lie and do not practice the truth. But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light we have fellowship with one another and the blood of Jesus his son cleanses us from all sin.”

Observations:_____(Ex: there is a relationship between the light and fellowship)

Application:_____ (Ex: What would it look like to lead with vulnerability instead of wait for others’ vulnerability?)

2. Persistent Intentionality (How would you define it?)

Hebrews 10:24-25- “Let us consider how to spur one another to love and good works, not neglecting to meet together as is the habit of some but encouraging one another, and all the more as you see the day drawing near”

Observations:_____(Ex: the first exhortation is “to consider”)

Application:_____ (Ex: “Consider” ways to initiate time with a friend, or carry the burden of planning a time to hangout)

3. Costly Humility (How would you define it?)

Ephesians 5:21 - “...submitting to one another out of reverence for Christ”
Proverbs 20:5 - “The purpose in a man's heart is like deep water, but a man of understanding will draw it out.”

Observations:_____(Ex: a man’s heart has waters they cannot search out alone)

Application:_____ (Ex: Invite someone to call out blind spots to sin in your life and avoid defensiveness. Ask a friend for help)

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